

Joaquín Zaragoza López

M.Sc. Student in Economics | Research Assistant

joaquinzarlop@gmail.com · +34 644 78 77 66 · Parkstraat 54, 3000 Leuven, Belgium · <https://linkedin.com/in/joaquinzaragozalopez> · <https://github.com/BUMBLI99>

PROFESSIONAL & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

November 2025 - July 2026 **Research Assistant · Economic Research Group, KU Leuven**

Leuven, Belgium

- Assisted Prof. Lukas Mahler with research on Lifestyle Behaviors and Wealth-Health Gaps in Germany (DOI: 10.3982/ECTA20603) through literature synthesis and replication of microeconomic code.
- Cleaned, curated, and harmonized complex regional panel datasets covering demographic and socioeconomic indicators across Germany using Stata.
- Supported empirical modeling by developing reproducible workflows for data analysis, statistical visualization, and regional geospatial mapping.

EDUCATION

September 2025 - Present **M.Sc. in Economics · KU Leuven**

Leuven, Belgium

- Relevant coursework: Advanced Macroeconomics I (DSGE & RBC Models), Advanced Macroeconomics II (VAR/SVAR Methods), and Advanced Microeconomics I.

September 2024 - July 2025 **Erasmus Exchange in Economics · KU Leuven**

Leuven, Belgium

- One-year exchange with graduate-level coursework. GPA: 14.5/20.

September 2021 - July 2025 **B.Sc. in Economics · Universitat de València**

Valencia, Spain

- GPA: 3.51/4.0 equivalent, with 13 Honorary Mentions.
- Honorary Mentions included Mathematics I & II, Statistics I & II, Econometrics I & II, Microeconomics I & II, and Macroeconomics II.
- Academic excellence award for best academic record; Premi Extraordinari de Grau 2024/2025.

RESEARCH PAPERS

2025 **Latin America as a Monetary Union: A Reassessment of the Viability in the Context of Optimal Currency Area Theory**

Undergraduate Thesis, Universitat de València

- Empirical assessment of trade integration and economic openness, factor mobility (labor and capital), and business-cycle synchronization within the Optimum Currency Area framework.
- Analysis of macroeconomic convergence and the feasibility of monetary integration.
- Grade: 100%.

2024 **Climate Change and Coffee Trade: Implications on Vietnam's Exports and Dutch Import Prices**

Term Paper, KU Leuven

- Empirical analysis of the effects of climate change on Vietnamese coffee exports and Dutch import prices.
- Grade: 100%.

COURSES & SUMMER SCHOOLS

2026

Empirical Macroeconomics Summer School

Ghent University, Belgium

- State-of-the-art Bayesian methods in structural VAR models for empirical research and policy analysis. Lecturer: Prof. dr. Christiane Baumeister.

2026

DSGE Modeling - Summer School and Conference

So.Fi.E., National Bank of Belgium

- Intensive training in Bayesian Structural Macroeconometrics, covering DSGE to HANK estimation, policy analysis, and forecasting. Instructors: Marco Del Negro and Frank Schorfheide.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software

Stata; R; MATLAB (Dynare); LaTeX

Other

Data cleaning; Data visualization; Reproducible-workflow management

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconometrics; Time Series Econometrics; Macroeconomic Forecasting; Monetary Economics; Inflation-at-Risk & Growth-at-Risk; Bayesian VARs & DSGE Models

LANGUAGES

Spanish

Native

Valencian/Catalan

Native

English

C2 (Cambridge CPE)

Dutch

A1+ (CEFR)